

APRIL

APRIL 1

Union forces break through the right wing of the Confederate lines outside Petersburg at Five Forks, threatening Lee's last supply line and making his position untenable.

APRIL 2

In face of a Union assault, Confederate forces withdraw from Petersburg after an eight-month siege. In Alabama, James H. Wilson's Union cavalry breaks through Confederate lines to capture Selma.

APRIL 2

The first Union troops arrive in Richmond, the day after the Confederate government has evacuated the city.

APRIL 6

Union forces pursuing Lee's retreating army cut off almost a quarter of the Confederate force at Saylor's Creek, capturing some 7,700 men.

APRIL 7

Union commander-in-chief Ulysses S. Grant sends a note to Lee inviting him to surrender. Lee temporizes, asking for details of the terms.